



St Gerard's Parish Weekly Bulletin

6th September 2026



Welcome to Celebrate Today's Liturgy Mass Times

Saturday Vigil- 18.30

Sunday Mass—10.30

Monday—Liturgy of The Word 9.30

Tuesday Mass -9.30

Wednesday Mass- 9.30

Thursday OMPH Novena Prayer Service- 9.30

Thursday OMPH Novena Mass—19.30

Friday Mass - 9.30

Saturday Silent Meditation—9.30

Holy Days Vigil 7.30pm Morning 9:30

Reconciliation Saturday 17.30—18.15
otherwise by appointment with Priest

Baptisms 2nd and 4th Sundays—Baptism
Preparation course 5pm on 1st Monday of each
month for those wishing to have their child Baptised
in St Gerard's—ring Parish office to arrange both.

Priest Fr Patrick O'Keeffe CSsR ADM

Parish Office 028 90 774833
726 Antrim Road (office hrs M-F 9.30-1.30)

Email stgerards@downandconnor.org

Website stgerardsparish.org

Church Services: Our live streaming web
address has been updated. To access MCN
Media, please go to www.mcn.live on your web
browser. THE CHURCH WEBCAM CAN BE ACCESSED
VIA

mcn.live/Camera/st-gerards-church-newtownabbey

(Playback available on **Recorded** services only -
Recording Requests can be made through Parish
office)

**For Anniversary Mass Intentions on preferred dates—
Please (if possible) make requests 3-4 weeks in advance*

The Apostles' Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty,
Creator of heaven and earth,
and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit,
born of the Virgin Mary,
suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died and was buried;
he descended into hell;
on the third day
he rose again from the dead;
he ascended into heaven,
and is seated at the right hand of
God the Father almighty;
from there he will come to judge the
living and the dead.
I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic Church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and life everlasting. Amen.

Congratulations to Mrs Briege Smyth

We are delighted to announce that His Holiness Pope Leo XIV
has conferred the Benemerenti Medal on Mrs Briege Smyth in
recognition of her lifetime of dedicated service to St Gerard's
Church and Parish.
This prestigious papal honour is a fitting tribute to Briege's faithful
commitment, generosity, and years of service to our parish
community.
Please join us in congratulating Briege on this achievement and in
keeping her in your prayers as she receives this special recognition.
The Benemerenti Medal will be presented to Briege during the
10.30am Mass on Sunday, 6 September 2026.
All are warmly welcome to attend and share in this joyful
celebration. Tea and coffee will be served after Mass, providing an
opportunity for parishioners and friends to congratulate Briege
personally.
We thank Briege for her outstanding contribution to parish life and
celebrate this well-deserved honour with her and her family.

Our Parish Associate Pilgrims Collection for the Down and Connor
Diocesan Pilgrimage will take place this weekend 5th and 6th
September.

**Saturday 4th October at 3pm—Blessing of Pets— on this special day
of the Feast of St Frances all our pets are welcome to St Gerards
Church for a special blessing**

Opening Mass for the Season of Creation

6.00 pm on Sunday, 6th September in St. Patrick's Church, Donegall
Street, Belfast

Celebrant: Fr Piaras Jackson SJ, with interfaith contributions.

This Mass marks the beginning of the Season of Creation (1 Sept–4
Oct), a time when Christians worldwide commit to prayer and action
for our common home under the theme "Living Water".

1st September is the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation. In
his message for the occasion, Pope Leo said, "The prophetic call to
"beat swords into ploughshares" (Is 2:4) is (...) not only a vision for
nations, but a call to each person. It invites us to transform harm into
life. Yet this transformation cannot be achieved through external
change alone. It requires, through cooperating with God's grace, a
deeper personal and collective conversion — a returning to God, who
will reorder our desires, heal our wounds and help us grow in virtue."

The **Rise & Shine Trust** wishes to thank the parishioners of St Gerards
for your kind donations that amounted to £710.16 and 70 euro.
Remember if you know anyone who would benefit from next years
trip please contact

**Maurice on 07711504821 mauricediamond@gmail.com or visit
www.riseandshine.ie.**

LOCAL IRISH DANCE CLASSES – SEPTEMBER The Carson Academy of
Irish Dance welcomes **girls & boys aged 4+** to our fun and friendly
beginner Irish dance classes. **Mayfield Village Hall** Every Tuesday |
5:30–6:30pm **Glengormley Integrated Nursery School** Every Saturday
| 10:00–11:00am Classes commence **week of 7th September**.

Enquiries & Booking: WhatsApp: 07803 785103

Email: carson_acd@icloud.com New beginners are very welcome!

Craobh Naomh Pádraig will begin Irish/Gaeilge classes on
Wednesday 16 September 2026 at 7 p.m.

Classes will be held in Arás Mhic Reachtain, 283-289 Antrim Road
(opposite waterworks).

Term will last for 12 weeks finishing on Wed 9 December.

Cost per term for adults £30. Teenagers - no cost.

All levels available: bunrang, meánrang, meán rang uachtar, ardrang
and class for teenagers.

EUCARISTIC ADORATION – Down and Connor Diocese is renewing
and developing its **Diocesan Adoration Lay Committee** in order to
increase the practice of Eucharistic Adoration in parishes throughout
the diocese. You are welcome to attend an Information Meeting at
ONE of these venues

Thur 1st October The Parish Centre Ballymena – 2 Broughshane Road
BT43 7DX 8pm

Fri 2nd October St Patrick's Centre Downpatrick – Market Street BT30
6LZ 8pm

Registration from 7.30pm . See poster in the church porch for details

New Lodge Grotto Monday 7th September 6.30pm Rosary at the
Grotto 7pm Holy Mass at the Grotto with Fr Francis O'Brien and Fr
John O'Laverty Followed by refreshments All welcome!

EVERYONE IS INVITED TO STAY AFTER MASS THIS WEEKEND
AND JOIN US FOR COFFEE/TEA AND CHAT

PASTORAL COMMUNITY

HOLY FAMILY PARISH CLERGY

Very Rev. Michael Spence PP

Rev. John O'Laverty CC

Rev. Brendan Dowd Deacon

Mass Times

HOLY FAMILY CHURCH,

14 Newington Avenue, Belfast, BT15 2HP

Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 10.30am

Holydays: 9.15am

Weekdays: Mon–Wed 9.15am

Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Wed at 9.15am

First Saturday Devotions: First Saturday of the month at 10am

ST THERÉSE OF LISIEUX CHURCH,

71 Somerton Road, Belfast, BT15 4DE

Sunday: 9am & 12pm

Holydays: 7pm Vigil & 10am

Weekdays: Thurs–Sat 10am

Eucharistic Adoration: Mon–Sat, 10am–4pm

ST. PATRICK'S PARISH

CLERGY

Very Rev. Francis O'Brien PP

Mass Times

ST PATRICK'S CHURCH

199 Donegall St Belfast BT1 2FL

Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 9am, 11am & 6pm

Holydays: Please check parish website and Facebook

Weekdays: Tues, Wed, Thurs 10am

Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help

every Wednesday at 10am

Novena in honour of St. Anthony and Blessing with the relic of

St Anthony of Padua every Tuesday at 10am

Pioneer Gathering – Sunday 27 September

A meeting for all Pioneers who are interested in helping to
renew and strengthen the Pioneer Association in Down &
Connor will take place on:

Sunday 27 September at 3.00 pm in Holy Family Gathering
Space, Holy Family Church, Newington Avenue, Belfast.

This gathering is open to all Pioneers, especially those who
would like to support a fresh start, new energy,
and renewed commitment within our diocese. We would be
delighted to welcome as many Pioneers as possible.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved
parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening
on **Monday 14th September at 7.30pm in the Crowne
Plaza, Shaws Bridge, Belfast.**

This event is free and open to all bereaved parents
regardless of the age their child died, the circumstances of
their death, or how recent their death was. You do not need
to register in advance.

We also offer an online support group meeting. To find out
more call 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

We're grateful for your help in raising awareness of
this free support for bereaved parents in your parish
community. For more information visit www.anamcara.ie.

September 2026 Shopping List

- Coffee
- Soup
- Jam
- Tea
- Baked beans



northbelfast.foodbank.org.uk
Registered Charity in Northern Ireland (94C100211)

Ending hunger together



May They Rest In Peace



Recently Deceased

Months Mind

Pat Rogan

Anniversaries

James Richard Hann, John Hicks, Frank McGoldrick, Malachy Quail,

Patrick and Mary Anne Canning, Denis and Ellen Lane